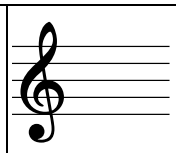
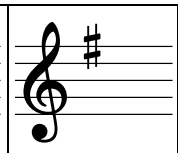
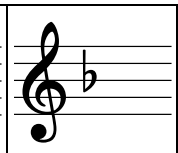
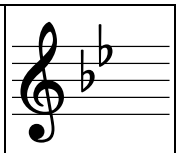
Relative Minor Keys

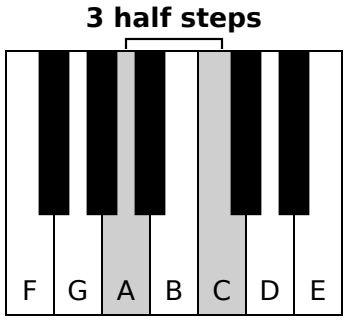
Every key signature names two keys: a major key and a minor key. Keys that share a key signature are **relative keys**. The minor key is the **relative minor** of the major key, and the major key is the **relative major** of the minor key. A minor key is named, like a major key, for its tonic.

Key signature							
Major key	**C**	**G**	**D**	**A**	**F**	**B♭**	**E♭**
Relative minor	**A**	**E**	**B**	**F♯**	**D**	**G**	**C**

Finding the relative minor

The tonic of the relative minor is degree 6 of the major scale. It is also a minor 3rd below the major tonic: three half steps down, and three letter names down.

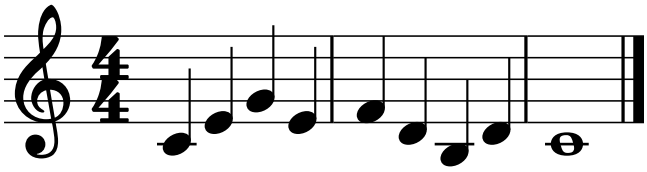
- From major to minor: count down three half steps and three letters. C major: C, B, A, so A minor.
- From minor to major: count up three half steps and three letters. E minor: E, F♯, G, so G major.
- Keep the letter count. Three half steps below E♭ is C, written C, not B♯: E♭ major and C minor.



A is three half steps below C.

Major or minor?

A key signature alone does not say whether a piece is major or minor. Two clues decide it. First, the last note of the melody, or of the bass line, is almost always the tonic. Second, minor pieces often raise degree 7 with an accidental, such as G♯ in A minor (Chapter 22 explains why).


No sharps or flats, ends on C: C major


No sharps or flats, ends on A, uses G♯: A minor

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Name _____ Date _____

Relative Keys

A. Relative minor Write the relative minor of each major key.

EXAMPLE C major: A minor

1. G major: _____
2. F major: _____
3. D major: _____
4. B♭ major: _____
5. A major: _____
6. E♭ major: _____

B. Relative major Write the relative major of each minor key.

EXAMPLE A minor: C major

1. E minor: _____
2. D minor: _____
3. B minor: _____
4. G minor: _____
5. F♯ minor: _____
6. C minor: _____

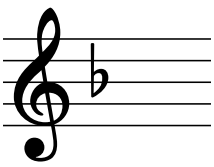
C. Name the minor key Write the name of the minor key for each key signature.

EXAMPLE



E minor

1.



_____

2.



_____

3.



_____

4.



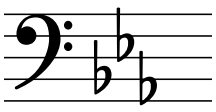
_____

5.



_____

6.



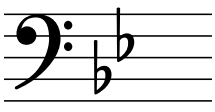
_____

7.



_____

8.



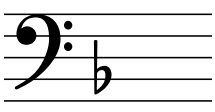
_____

9.



_____

10.



_____

11.



_____

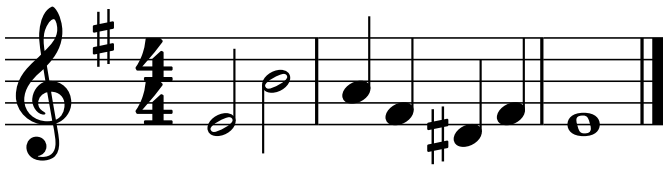
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Name _____ Date _____

Major or Minor?

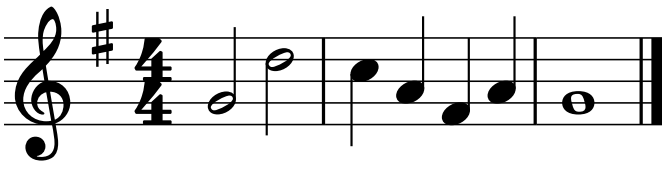
A. Name the key Read the key signature, then the last note. Write the key, such as G major or E minor.

EXAMPLE

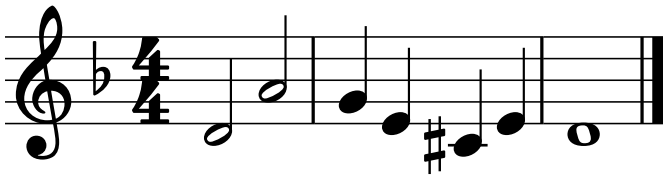


E minor

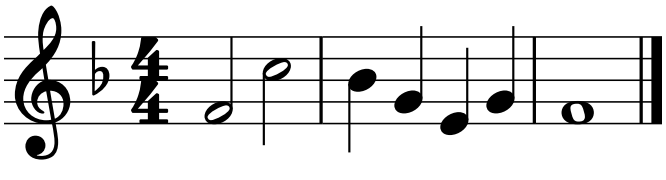
1.



2.



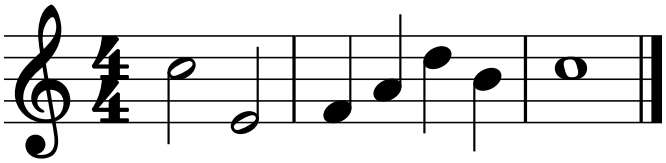
3.



4.



5.



6.

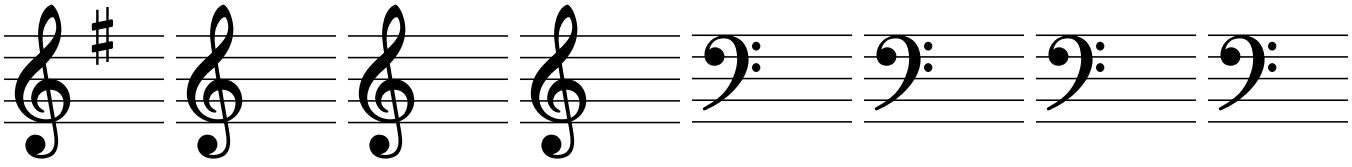


7.



B. Write the key signature Write the key signature for each minor key.

EXAMPLE 1. 2. 3. 4. 5. 6. 7.



E minor D minor B minor C minor G minor F♯ minor A minor D minor

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